My father taught me not to judge people too quickly.

That habit made other men trust me with their secrets.

I did not always want those secrets, but I still tried to reserve judgment.

After I came back from the East, I wanted the world to stand at moral attention.

Only Gatsby escaped my disgust.


I saw in Gatsby an extraordinary gift for hope.


I thought Gatsby was all right; the corruption around his dream was not.


I came from a well-to-do Midwestern family.


I went to Yale, served in the war, and came home restless.


My father financed my move East to learn bonds in spring 1922.

A man at the office and I planned to share a house near the city.

I went out alone when my coworker was sent to Washington.

I kept an old Dodge, a housekeeper, and briefly a dog.

A newer arrival stopped me on the road and asked the way to West Egg village.

I told him, and I felt lonely no longer.

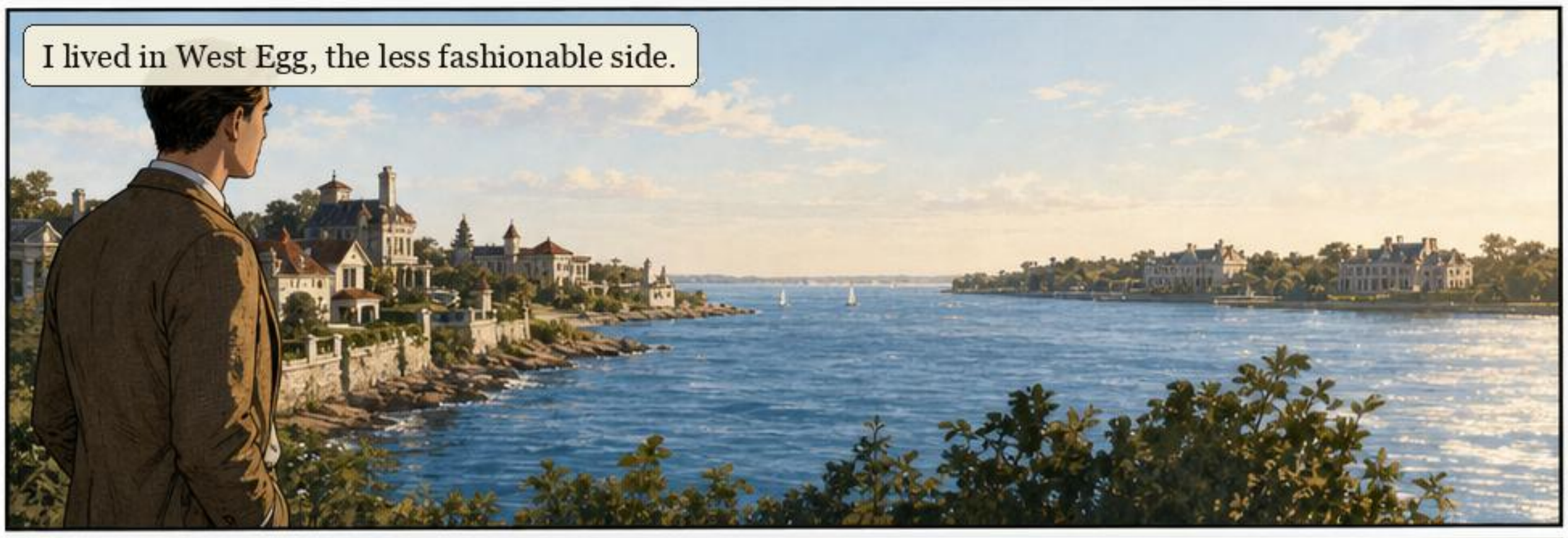
I felt like a guide, a pathfinder, an original settler.

With summer beginning, I felt the neighborhood open to me.

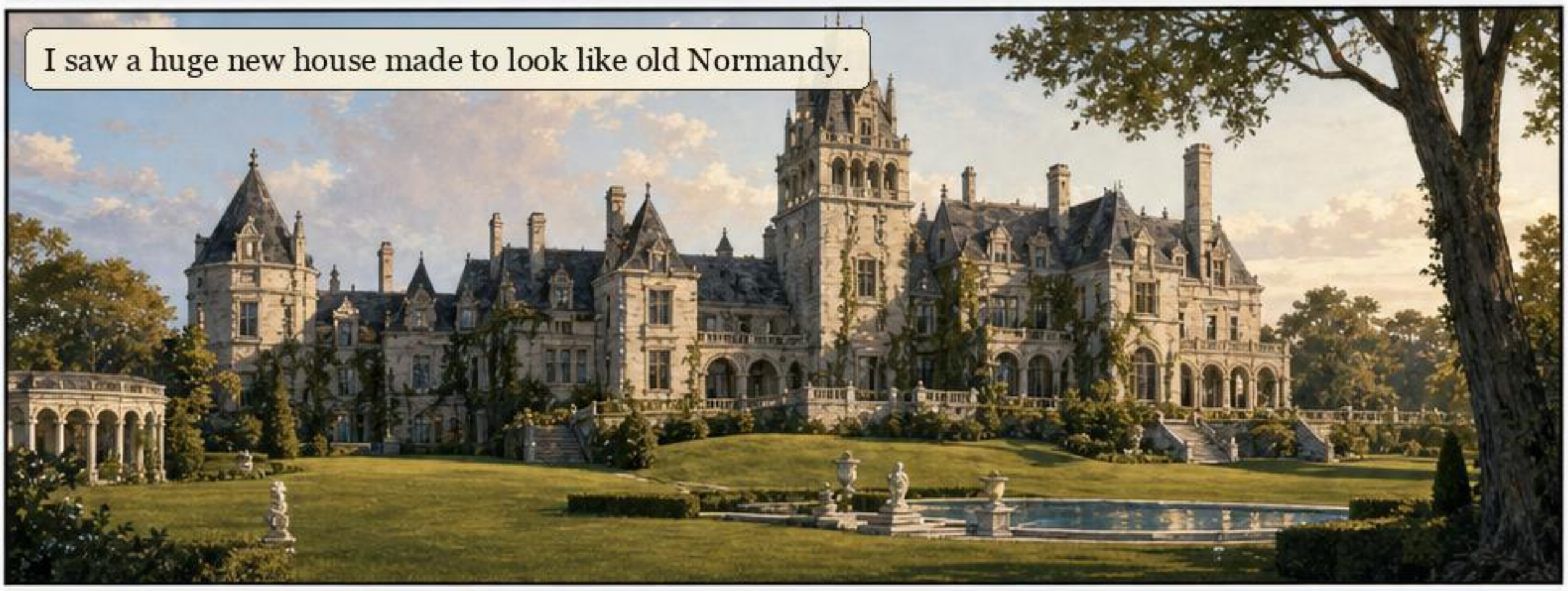
I bought books on banking and credit for my new work.

I wanted to become well-rounded again.

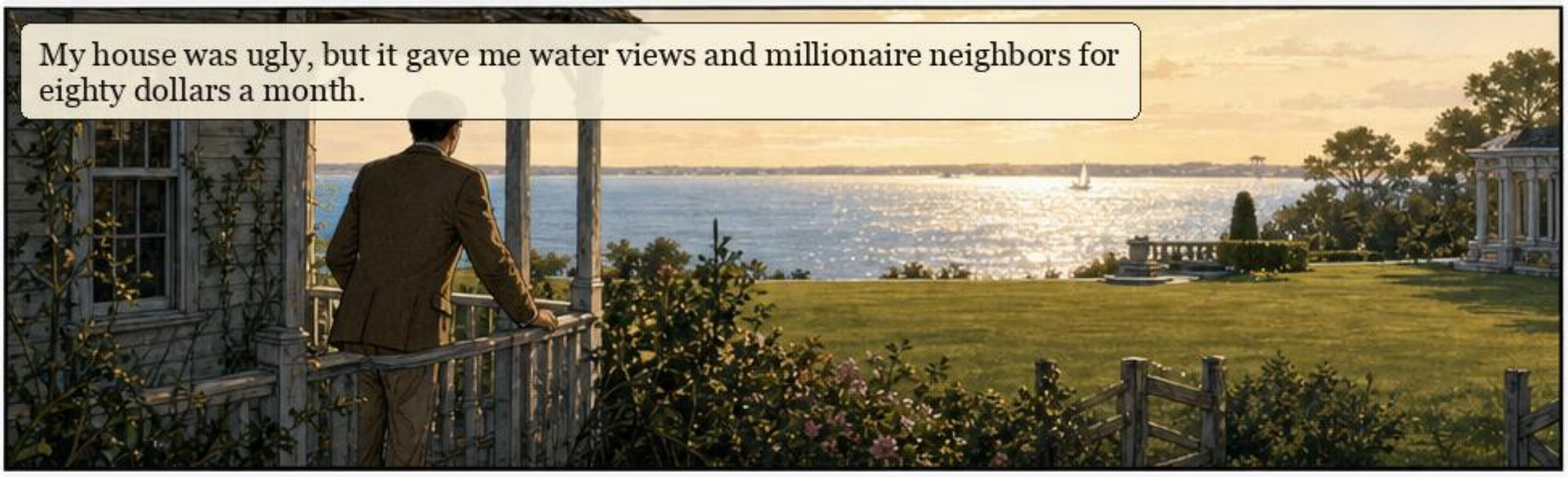
From the shore, I saw the two Eggs across the bay.


I lived in West Egg, the less fashionable side.

My little house was squeezed between two enormous rented estates.


I saw a huge new house made to look like old Normandy.


I knew only that it was Gatsby's mansion.


My house was ugly, but it gave me water views and millionaire neighbors for eighty dollars a month.